v) Right to Seek Redressal

This step is one step ahead of the previous right. The complaints and protests are not just to be heard: but the aggrieved party is to be granted compensation within a reasonable time period . There should be prompt settlement of complaints and claims lodged by the aggrieved customers. This will boost consumer confidence and help render justice to buyers. There should be fair and just settlement of deserving claims in a definite timeframe.

vi) Right to Consumer Education

The consumer has a right to acquire knowledge and stay well-informed all through his life. He should be aware about his rights and the reliefs granted to him where a product or service falls short of his expectations. Many consumer organisations and some enlightened businesses are taking a pro active part in educating consumers in this respect.



vii) Right to Quality of Life

Quality of life refers to the perceived well-being of people, in groups and individually, and well-being of the environment in which these people live. Consumerism has been defined as 'an improved quality of life." It means that the environmental problems affect the very life of consumers and on the environment which people live. In other words air pollution, water pollution, food pollution, noise pollution, and relation pollution, and legacies of on-going industrialisation take a heavy toll on the quality of life of people and on the environment of their inhabitation. The social cost of these pollutions far exeed their social benefits. In other words, each kind of pollution is eating away the social benefits resulting from the society. It is where the social responsibilities of business enterprises arise; there is nothing wrong in producing the products/output for the mankind. But the manufacturers have to safely dispose the inevitable sewage and effluent in such a way that it does not cause any damage to human or environment.

viii) Right to Consumer Protection

The consumer has a right to be aware of his rights and remedies available to him, redress his grievances through publicity in the mass media. Consumer has a right to be protected against goods and services which are hazardous to life and health. For instance, electrical appliances which are manufactured with substandard components or which do not conform to the safety norms might cause serious physical injury to the user. Therefore, consumers need to be educated that they should use electrical appliances with ISI mark which stands testimony to the quality and standards observed in the manufacturers.

ix) Right to Basic Needs

Every consumer has a right to get basic necessities of life such as food, clothing and water, and right to pure and healthy environment. It is the latest addition to consumer bill of rights. Community life should be free from various modes of pollution. This will enhance the quality of human life.

17.02 Duties of Consumers

Apart from rights, there are certain duties imposed on the consumer. Consumer

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